Private beta

PerfoAds MCP
Setup and user guide

Connect your AI assistant to your Google Ads account. Ask questions in plain English, run a full account check, and make changes only after you approve them.

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Works with Claude Desktop, Claude Code, Cursor, ChatGPT desktop and Codex
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1. What PerfoAds MCP does

It is a small program that runs on your own computer. It lets your AI assistant work with your Google Ads account.

- **Look:** ask about campaigns, keywords, search terms, budgets, ads and conversions. Nothing changes.
- **Check:** 162 fixed checks look through the whole account and list what is wrong, with the numbers behind each problem.
- **Change:** budgets, pausing, bid targets, negative keywords, keywords, ad text, sitelinks, callouts, audience exclusions, and new Search campaigns.

> **The safety rule.** No change goes live until you approve it on a page outside the chat, with a 6-character code. The AI saying "yes" approves nothing. Changes are switched off until you turn them on for an account.

Your data goes only between your computer and Google. Nothing is sent to PerfoAds. There is no tracking.

The checks say what is wrong. They do not say how to fix it. For fix plans, PerfoAds offers a free 1-hour call with Pawel: perfoads.com

PerfoAds MCP works with Google Ads. It is not made or supported by Google.

2. What you need before you start

- A Mac, Windows or Linux computer.
- **Node.js version 22.13 or newer.** Get it at nodejs.org. To check, open Terminal and type `node --version`.
- A Google account that can open your Google Ads account.
- Your own **Google Cloud project**. It is free. Section 3 shows how.
- One AI app: Claude Desktop, Claude Code, Cursor, ChatGPT desktop or Codex.

> **Beta note.** PerfoAds MCP is not in the public app stores or on npm yet. During the beta you install it from the PerfoAds code folder you were given access to. Section 4 covers this.

3. Set up Google (about 15 minutes)

You do this once. It gives the program its own key to your Google Ads, owned by you.

1. **Create a project.** Go to console.cloud.google.com, sign in, and create a new project. Call it something like "My PerfoAds MCP".
2. **Turn on the Google Ads API.** Menu: APIs & Services > Library. Search "Google Ads API". Click **Enable**.
3. **Set up the sign-in screen.** Menu: Google Auth Platform (OAuth consent screen). Pick **External**. Give the app a name and add your email. Under Audience, add your own Google account as a test user.
4. **Create the app key.** Google Auth Platform > Clients > Create client. Type: **Desktop app**. Copy the **client ID** and **client secret**. Keep them private.
5. **Ask for Explorer access.** On the Google Ads API page of your project, apply for **Explorer** access. Until Google approves it, only Google Ads test accounts work. Ours was approved the same day.
6. **Stop the weekly sign-out (recommended).** While your app is in "Testing", Google signs you out every 7 days. To avoid it: Google Auth Platform > Audience > **Publish app**. Google may show an "unverified app" warning when you sign in. For an app only you use, you can click past it.

> **How much can it do per day?** Explorer access allows 2,880 Google Ads requests a day on live accounts. Test accounts get 15,000. Keyword ideas need a higher access level (Basic).
>
> **The limit is yours alone.** It belongs to your own Google Cloud project, so other users never use up your share.

How far it goes. Normal questions about one account use a few hundred requests a day. A product-by-product review of a big shop over several months can use 2,000 or more on its own. If you hit the limit often, ask for **Basic** (15,000 a day): finish brand verification for your project first (Google Auth Platform, then Branding: app name, logo, home page, privacy page), then on the Google Ads API Overview page click **Apply for access** under Basic.

4. Install and connect your AI app

Step 1: Install

Open Terminal and run these lines one by one:

```
git clone https://github.com/vilovibe/perfoads-mcp.git
cd perfoads-mcp
pnpm install --frozen-lockfile && pnpm build
node packages/cli/bin/perfoads-mcp.js init
```

No `pnpm`? Run `npm install -g pnpm` first.

Step 2: Let the setup guide you

The last line starts the setup. It will:

1. ask for your client ID and client secret from Section 3,
2. ask your access level (pick Explorer once Google approved it),
3. open Google's sign-in page in your browser,
4. save your sign-in, locked and encrypted, on your computer,
5. write a starter rules file that allows looking only, no changes,
6. test everything,
7. print the exact lines to paste into your AI app.

Step 3: Connect your AI app

Paste the lines the setup printed:

- **Claude Desktop:** Settings > Developer > Edit Config. Paste the block, save, and restart Claude.
- **Claude Code:** run the `claude mcp add ...` line it printed.
- **Cursor:** paste the block into `~/.cursor/mcp.json`.
- **ChatGPT desktop:** Settings > MCP servers > Add server, type STDIO, with the command and file path the setup printed.
- **Codex:** `codex mcp add perfoads-mcp --` followed by the command it printed. Set the tool time limit to 300 seconds, because a full check can take a few minutes.

Step 4: Test it

> "Check my PerfoAds setup."

> "Which Google Ads accounts can you see?"

The first one tests the sign-in, access and rules, and tells you what to fix. The second lists every account you can reach, including those under manager accounts.

5. What to ask

You never call anything yourself. You talk to your AI app the way you would talk to a colleague. **Always name the account** ("in the Acme account" or its 10-digit number) if you have more than one.

Overview

> "Give me an overview of the Acme account for the last 30 days."

> "Which campaigns spent the most last week, and what did they bring in?"

Setup

> "What are the budgets and bid strategies of all live campaigns?"

> "Which conversions are set up, and which count towards bidding?"

Search terms and keywords

> "Show search terms from the last 14 days that cost money and never converted."

> "List keywords with a low Quality Score."

History

> "What did anyone change in this account in the last 7 days?"

> "Show the ads and assets of ad group Y."

Answers come as a short summary first. Say "show more" for the next rows. Money is in the account's own currency. If your question is not covered by the list above, ask anyway.

6. Run a full account check

> "Run a full audit of the Acme account."

The AI takes a copy of the account, runs all 162 checks on it, and writes a report grouped by area: tracking, settings, budget and bidding, search and keywords, ads and landing pages, Performance Max, Shopping, audiences and devices, Demand Gen, and trends.

Each check ends in one of these:

- **Problem found:** what is wrong, where, and the numbers that prove it.
- **Info:** worth knowing, not a problem.
- **Clean:** checked, nothing wrong.
- **Not run:** it could not check, with the reason. This never means "fine".

Good follow-ups: "Explain check X", "Show only the problems in campaign Z", "Show only the urgent ones".

7. Make changes safely

Step 1: Switch changes on for one account

Changes are off at the start. Open the rules file `policy.yaml`. It is in `~/.config/perfoads-mcp/` on Mac and Linux, or `%APPDATA%\perfoads-mcp\` on Windows. Add the account under `write`:

```
version: 1
accounts:
  allow: ["123-456-7890"]
  write: ["123-456-7890"]
```

The same file can set spend limits per account, how big a budget step may be, how many changes per day, and brand words that may never be blocked. The AI cannot edit this file. Tip: try your first changes on a Google Ads test account.

Step 2: Ask for the change in plain words

> "Lower the budget of campaign X to 40 a day."

> "Pause campaign Y."

> "Change the target ROAS of campaign Z to 400%."

> "Add 'free' and 'cheap' as phrase-match negative keywords to campaign X."

> "Change headline 3 of the ad in ad group Y to 'Handmade in Amsterdam'."

> "Add a sitelink 'Size guide' to campaign X, linking to yoursite.com/size-guide."

Step 3: What happens next

1. **Google tests it first** without changing anything, and your rules are checked.
2. **A page opens in your browser.** It shows the account, the exact change, every campaign it touches, and the AI's reason in a separate box marked "unverified".
3. **You approve** with the 6-character code on that page, or reject it. The link works for 10 minutes.
4. **It is sent once.** If the account changed since you approved, nothing is sent and you are told why.
5. **It is checked.** The program reads the account again to confirm the change landed.

New Search campaigns

> "Create a Search campaign 'Belts US' with 30 a day, Maximize conversions, United States, English, one ad group 'Leather belts' with these keywords, and this ad: ..."

New campaigns are **always created paused**. Check it in Google Ads, then say "switch on campaign 'Belts US'". That is a second change, with its own approval.

8. Undo, history and the stop switch

> "What did you change this week?"

> "Undo the budget change on campaign X."

- An undo is a new change with its own approval.
- Most changes can be undone for 30 days.
- A new campaign can be undone only while it has never run, and from 15 minutes after it was made.
- For sitelinks and callouts, undo removes them from the campaign. The text stays in your asset library.
- Applied Google recommendations cannot be undone.

Stop everything. Put `kill_switch: true` in `policy.yaml`. From then on every change is refused, undo included. Looking still works.

9. When something goes wrong

- **First, always:** say "Check my PerfoAds setup". It names the problem and the fix.
- **"Not approved for production":** Google has not approved your Explorer access yet, so only test accounts work. See Section 3, step 5.
- **Signed out after a week:** your Google app is still in Testing. Sign in again with `node packages/cli/bin/perfoads-mcp.js auth`, or publish the app (Section 3, step 6).
- **Out of daily requests:** Google limits requests per day. The allowance refills within a day. Reading pauses before the last share so approved changes and undos can still go through. Hitting it often? Ask for Basic access (see Section 3).
- **Claude Desktop does not start it:** check that Node.js is 22.13 or newer, then restart Claude.
- **Anything else:** email contact@perfoads.com.

10. Your data and privacy

- Everything is stored in one folder on your computer: `~/.config/perfoads-mcp` (Mac, Linux) or `%APPDATA%\perfoads-mcp` (Windows).
- Your Google sign-in is encrypted. It is never shown in the chat or written to logs.
- Account copies used for checks are deleted after 24 hours.
- Change history and the approval log are kept for 180 days by default.
- Data goes only between your computer and Google. Your AI app sees the answers it asks for.

Remove it completely

1. Run `node packages/cli/bin/perfoads-mcp.js reset`. It asks Google to cancel the sign-in and deletes it.
2. Delete the settings folder above.
3. Optional: remove the app at myaccount.google.com/permissions and delete the client in your Google Cloud project.

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